

A Very Strong El Niño Could Change Weather Around the World

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Weather experts say Earth could have the strongest **El Niño** ever recorded this year. Some people call it "Super **El Niño**," NPR reports.

El Niño is a natural pattern that happens every two to seven years. It starts when a big area of ocean water near the **equator** in the Pacific gets warm. That warm water heats the air and changes weather around the world.

Scientist Daniel Vimont says it is like dropping a giant rock into a pond. Even places far away feel the waves.

Forecasters at **NOAA**, a U.S. weather agency, call this one "very strong." Ocean water in one key area is more than 2 degrees Celsius warmer than normal. They think it will last into early 2027.

In the United States, southern states often get more rain during **El Niño**. That can cause **floods**, but it can also help dry places get water. Northern states are often warmer and drier.

Word Treasure

El Niño -- A natural pattern where Pacific Ocean water gets warm and changes weather.

equator -- An imaginary line around the middle of Earth.

forecaster -- A person who predicts the weather.

NOAA -- A U.S. government agency that studies weather and oceans.

flood -- When a lot of water covers land that is usually dry.

Break it down

Experts predict a record El Niño

What El Niño is

A rock-in-a-pond comparison

How strong this one is

What it could mean for U.S. weather

Why it matters

El Niño can change rain and temperatures where people live, so knowing about it helps families and communities prepare.

Test what you remember

1. What could Earth have this year?

- ☐ (A) No weather at all
- ☐ (B) The coldest winter ever for sure
- ☐ (C) The strongest El Niño ever recorded
- ☐ (D) A new ocean

2. How often does El Niño happen?

- ☐ (A) Every day
- ☐ (B) Once every 100 years
- ☐ (C) Only in summer
- ☐ (D) Every two to seven years

3. What starts an El Niño?

- ☐ (A) The Moon gets closer
- ☐ (B) Snow falls in the desert
- ☐ (C) Ocean water near the equator in the Pacific gets warm
- ☐ (D) Volcanoes erupt

4. What does Daniel Vimont compare El Niño to?

- ☐ (A) A melting ice cube
- ☐ (B) A giant rock dropped into a pond
- ☐ (C) A rocket launch
- ☐ (D) A big storm cloud

5. How long do forecasters think this El Niño will last?

- ☐ (A) It already ended
- ☐ (B) Until 2030
- ☐ (C) Just one week
- ☐ (D) Into early 2027

6. What often happens in southern U.S. states during El Niño?

- ☐ (A) No rain at all
- ☐ (B) Earthquakes
- ☐ (C) More snow every day
- ☐ (D) More rain

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: C 4: B 5: D 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):